

LIZ LENJO, Advocate of the High Court of Kenya

Liz Lenjo is an accomplished legal practitioner and governance leader with a distinguished record across intellectual property, regulated industries, and complex commercial environments. She is the Founder and Managing Consultant of MyIP Legal Studio, a boutique advisory firm serving clients across Africa's creative, digital, technology, and energy sectors.

Liz currently serves as Chairperson of the Copyright Tribunal, Kenya's specialized court constituted under Section 48 of the Copyright Act (CAP 130). In this role, she offers strategic judicial leadership on disputes involving commercial rights, licensing, compliance, and cross-border exploitation of intangible assets—experience that directly translates into modern governance demands in sectors such as international shipping, maritime IP, logistics technologies, digital platforms, and supply-chain management.

She has served on the Board of the Nuclear Power and Energy Agency (NuPEA) under the Energy Act (2019), where she assisted in overseeing corporate governance, policy alignment, and risk management for a state corporation operating in a high-compliance, security-sensitive, and globally regulated environment. She additionally provided expertise on intellectual property strategy, technology transfer, and regulatory frameworks. She served as the Chairperson of the Human Resource and General Purpose Committee, Finance and Strategic Planning Committee, and the Audit Committee.

Liz is also a volunteer and is currently Head of Legal at Partners Against Piracy and the Interim Chairperson of the Kenya Fashion Council and Head of its Legal, Policy, and Intellectual Property portfolio. She has extensive experience in stakeholder engagement, organisational structuring, and guiding industry bodies through regulatory reforms—competencies essential to boardrooms steering growth, market positioning, and strategic transformation.

An adjunct faculty member at Strathmore University Law School, Liz teaches Media and Entertainment Law and also tutors with CopyrightX (HarvardX – Kenya). She chairs the Intellectual Property Technical Committee at the Kenya Bureau of Standards (KEBS), reinforcing her fluency with standards, compliance, certification processes, and cross-sector regulatory ecosystems.

Liz holds an LL.M. in Intellectual Property Law (University of Turin & WIPO), an LL.B. from the Catholic University of Eastern Africa, and a Postgraduate Diploma from the Kenya School of Law. She has additional professional certifications in IP management, mediation, arbitration, and fashion law from globally recognized institutions, including the WIPO Academy and Fordham University School of Law.

A published scholar, her LL.M. thesis—*"Inspiration versus Exploitation: Traditional Cultural Expressions at the Hem of the Fashion Industry"*—is published in the Marquette Intellectual Property Law Review and available on Westlaw and Nexis. She has written for and been featured in major local and international media on matters of IP, governance, digital innovation, and emerging creative industries.

Her global profile includes consulting for governments through WIPO, international development institutions, and pan-African economic forums such as CANEX by Afreximbank, GiZ, and the Intra-African Trade Fair. She has presented and moderated at industry and policy events across Africa and beyond on IP, trade, creative economy governance, and cross-border commerce.

Liz has received numerous recognitions, including Business Daily Top 40 Under 40 Women 2018, WIPR Diversity Shining Lights (2021), Top 25 Women in Digital – Kenya, Africa Legal Innovation Awards' IP Lawyer of the Year (2022), and two consecutive honours as a Beacon of Light by WIPR Diversity (2022), WTR (World Trademark Review) Bronze Award - 2024, 2025 and 2026, and Chambers and Partners 2026 Band 3 mention in Intellectual Property Law Practice.

A member of the International Trademark Association (INTA), Liz has served on several of its global committees, including the Anti-Counterfeiting Committee and Programming Council. Her international involvement strengthens her understanding of global supply chain IP risks, anti-counterfeiting interventions, cross-border enforcement, digital trade, branding, and the commercial realities of international logistics.